

The largest maternity review in NHS history

4 divisions 2,157 written questions 228 distinct askers

The gravest business of the week was a report the House could barely bear to read. On 24 June the Health and Social Care Secretary, James Murray, responded to Donna Ockenden's review of maternity services at Nottingham University Hospitals. It was "the largest into a maternity service in the history of the NHS," covering thirteen years, 2,536 affected families and 838 staff. Its findings were, in Murray's word, "chilling." Women were not listened to. Bullying was rife. There was "a culture of cover-up at the highest levels of the trust." Failures in the care of babies who died are now under police investigation. Murray apologised and extended Martha's rule, the right to a second opinion, to every maternity and neonatal setting. On 30 June he returned with a second statement, on Baroness Amos's national maternity investigation and the first maternity commissioner it will create. Around that reckoning the Chamber turned to trade, defence and borders.

THE WEEK IN BRIEF

Defence Investment Plan, 30 June. Dan Jarvis set out the plan on the eve of the NATO summit and conceded that most inherited programmes were over budget.

Steel and the Union, 25 and 30 June. Chris Bryant's steel safeguard took effect on 1 July. Jim Allister of the Traditional Unionist Voice then forced an urgent question on how it applies in Northern Ireland.

Prime Minister's Questions, 24 June. This was Sir Keir Starmer's first since announcing his resignation. When a Conservative heckled "Did you meet Andy?", he replied "Not today," to laughter, a nod to Andy Burnham, the rival now back on the benches.

Royal Assent, 26 June. The Children's Wellbeing and Schools Act, the vehicle for the under-16 social-media ban, is now law.

THE DIVISIONS, CLOSEST FIRST

Customs (Tariff) Regulations



Carried by 163 on 24 June

Climate Change Act, Aviation and Shipping



Carried by 235 on 24 June

Climate Change Act, Credit Limit



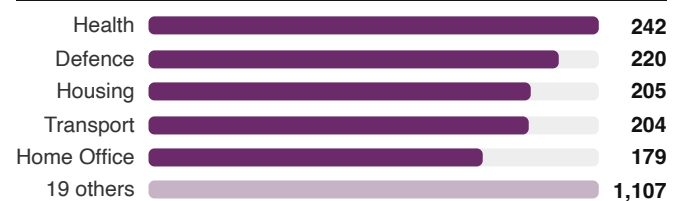
Carried by 237 on 24 June

Carbon Budget Order



Carried by 238 on 24 June

WRITTEN QUESTIONS, BY DEPARTMENT



THE MOST-ASKED SUBJECTS

12 Natural History: GCSE 11 Social Security Benefits: Debts 10 Defence: Finance 9 Energy: Housing 8 Asylum: Housing

A SAMPLE OF THE WEEK'S QUESTIONS

Roads: Temperature · Ayoub Khan, Independent
What assessment her Department has made of the resilience of road surfaces to increasingly frequent periods of extreme heat.

THE ANSWER The Department and Met Office have published evidence that road surfaces are typically tested to withstand temperatures up to 60 degrees celsius. However, some roads may begin to soften at lower temperatures.

Infected Blood Compensation Scheme · Navendu Mishra, Labour

What steps he is taking to ensure the most timely and thorough delivery of the Infected Blood Compensation Scheme.

THE ANSWER The delivery of compensation is a matter for the Infected Blood Compensation Authority (IBCA). IBCA has opened the service for the first claims from infected people who were never compensated, for deceased infected people, and for living affected people.

FEATURE

The asylum press: forty-one questions, five members

The single biggest written-question theme of the week was not, as it usually is, a broad concern raised by many members from many directions. It was a concentrated press of forty-one questions on asylum accommodation, appeals and cost, tabled by just five members and dominated by two. Andrew Snowden (Conservative) tabled sixteen and Rupert Lowe (Restore Britain) fifteen.